

AMINE MERVE ERCAN

PhD, Adult and Continuing Education | EdTech Researcher | Game-Based & AI-Supported Learning
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ACADEMIC PROFILE

An academic whose work rests equally on teaching and research within Adult and Continuing Education. Since 2021, has designed and delivered university-level courses on andragogy and on qualitative, quantitative, and mixed-methods research, in English and German, while conducting a doctoral research programme on digital, game-based interventions in entrepreneurship education at Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena. Academic training and prior experience span curriculum and instruction and mathematics education at Middle East Technical University (METU). Research contributions include peer-reviewed publications and presentations at international conferences (EARLI, ECER), including work co-authored and co-presented with mentored students, alongside a nomination for the university's Best Instructor of the Year Award in recognition of teaching. Research and founding activity has been supported by competitive grants (EXIST-Women, StarTH Gründungsstipendium, Impulse Förderung) and the Jacobs Foundation Presenter Award (EARLI). Fluent in Turkish, English, and German, with a sustained record of international academic collaboration across Türkiye and Germany.

EDUCATION

PhD, Adult and Continuing Education and Teaching

Oct 2021 – Dec 2025

Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena, Germany

- Degree: Magna Cum Laude
- EXIST Woman Grant - 2024
 - o The German Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Climate Action
- StarTH Gründungsstipendium Grant - 2025
 - o Thuringian Ministry for Economic Affairs, Science and Digital Society

PhD (transferred), Curriculum and Instruction

Oct 2020 – Sept 2021

Middle East Technical University (METU), Türkiye

- GPA: 4,00

PDQ Diploma, Teaching and Learning (First Module)

2019 – 2020

University of Cambridge, UK - Professional Development Qualifications Diploma

- gained from BLIS

MSc, Curriculum and Instruction

2017 – 2020

Middle East Technical University (METU), Türkiye

- EARLI - Jacobs Foundation Presenter Award - 2021
- TÜBİTAK Scholarship for Participation in Scientific Activities Abroad - 2021
- Conferences;
 - o ECER 2021
 - o EARLI 2021
 - o JURE 2019

BSc, German Language (Minor Program)

2016 – 2017

Middle East Technical University (METU), Türkiye

BSc, Elementary Education and Teaching

2012 – 2016

Middle East Technical University (METU), Türkiye

- completed in 3 years; 1 additional year in the Department of Basic English
- Honor Student (x2): Middle East Technical University - Jan & Jun 2016

Teacher Training High School

2008 – 2012

Hasan Ali Yücel Anadolu Öğretmen Lisesi

- The 2nd highest ranked teacher training high school of Türkiye

RESEARCH & ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Research Associate and Instructor

Oct 2021 – Present

Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena, Germany

Research Associate Role:

- Designed and validated AI-enhanced, game-based instructional frameworks applied in entrepreneurial and adult education contexts.
- Secured multiple competitive research and founding grants (EXIST-Women, StarTH Gründungsstipendium, Impulse Förderung) to develop an EdTech research-to-startup concept.
- Contributed to international academic collaboration and grant-writing processes (incl. DFG proposal preparation).

Instructor Role:

I offered 2 main courses for **bachelor and master students in 2 languages;**

Emotional, Cognitive and Affective Domains of Adult Education (Andragogy)

Winter 2021 – Spring 2026

- Winter 2021 - taught in English (Bachelor's level). **Nominated for the university's Best Instructor of the Year Award.**
- Winter 2024 - redesigned as an applied/practical seminar for Master's students; taught in German.
- Spring 2025 - taught in German (Bachelor's level).
- Winter 2025 - taught in German (Master's level).
- Spring 2026 - taught in German (Bachelor's level).

Research Methods (Qualitative, Quantitative, and Mixed Methods)

Spring 2022 – Spring 2024

- Spring 2022 - taught in English (Bachelor's level).
- Winter 2022 - taught in both English and German (Bachelor's level).
- Spring 2023 - taught in German (Bachelor's level).
- Winter 2023 - taught in German (Bachelor's level)
- Spring 2024 - taught in German (Master's level).

Mentored students from the Winter 2022 and Spring 2022 cohorts in developing their course assignments into conference papers; co-submitted and co-presented these papers with the students at ECER 2023 (University of Glasgow, UK), supported by an **Impulse Förderung Grant** from Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena.

Project Assistant

Oct 2019 – Oct 2021

Middle East Technical University (METU), Türkiye - Part-time

- AERA 2021

Mathematics Teacher

Aug 2020 – Aug 2021

MEV Koleji Özel Ankara Okulları, Türkiye

- Simultaneously continued part-time research assistant duty at METU

Mathematics & Sculpture Teacher

Aug 2019 – Aug 2020

Bilkent Laboratory and International School, Türkiye

- Simultaneously continued part-time research assistant duty at METU

Project Assistant

Oct 2018 – Aug 2019

Middle East Technical University (METU), Ankara, Türkiye

UI Designer

Apr 2025 – Jun 2025

Aksoy.Consulting, Germany - part-time

PUBLICATIONS

Generative Artificial Intelligence Policy: A Qualitative UNESCO Framework Analysis

2026

Adarkwah, M.A., Ercan, A.M., Schneider, K., Bayar, E. - *Journal of University Teaching and Learning Practice*, 23(2), 1–38.

- Cited by 2.
- SCImago/SJR 2025: 1.164, best quartile Q1 (Education); H-index 34. (2024 SJR was 0.909, also Q1 - the journal moved from Q2 to Q1 in 2024 and has held it since.)

Exploring the Impact of Online Anticipatory Reflection Intervention on Pre-service Math Teachers' Professional Teacher Identity Development

2025

Ercan, A.M., Çakır Akkuş, N., Yıldırım, A. - *Reflective Practice*, 27(2), 247–259.

- Article of Master Thesis
- SCImago/SJR: 0.657, best quartile Q1 (Philosophy); H-index 37. Published by Routledge/Taylor & Francis - the strongest venue in this list by SJR standing.

Development and Evaluation of a Digital Femalepreneurship Game: An Intervention Study

2025

Ercan, A.M. - *Friedrich Schiller Universität Jena*.

- Doctoral dissertation, not a peer-reviewed journal article - no quartile/h-index applies.

How University Teaching Staff Learn from Negative Student Feedback

2024

Schneider, K., Ercan, A.M., Bayar, E., Proskunina, U. - *Psychology*, 15, 1437–1454.

- Cited by 2.

Raising Scientists: A Phenomenological Study on Advisor-Advisee Relationships in Doctoral Education

2023

Burakgazi, S.G., Gökalp, G., Kaşıkçı, S.K., Yıldırım, H., Ercan, A.M., Yıldırım, A. - *Yükseköğretim Dergisi*, 13(2), 273–286.

- Cited by 8.

Effects of Quiz Games on Learning Motivation of Adult Learners of Online DaF Courses: An Intervention Study

Ercan, A.M., Xie, P. - *ECER 2023, Network 27: Didactics – Learning and Teaching*.

2023

- Conference paper (European Conference on Educational Research), presented in person at the University of Glasgow, UK. Co-authored and co-presented with a student mentee from the Research Methods course; developed from the student's course assignment and supported by an Impulse Förderung conference travel grant. No journal quartile/h-index applies.

Influence of Role-playing Games in Language Classes on the Intrinsic Learning Motivation of High School Students: A Quantitative Study

2023

Wurmstich, V., Ercan, A.M. - *ECER 2023, Network 27: Didactics – Learning and Teaching*.

- Conference paper (ECER), presented in person at the University of Glasgow, UK. Co-authored and co-presented with a student mentee from the Research Methods course; developed from the student's course assignment and supported by an Impulse Förderung conference travel grant. No journal quartile/h-index applies.

Pre-service Math Teachers' Professional Identity Development Through Online Anticipatory Reflections

2021

Ercan, A.M., Çakır, N., Yıldırım, A. - *ECER 2021, Network 10: Teacher Education Research*.

- Conference paper

A Pre-Service Math Teacher's Professional Identity Development Trajectory Through Online Reflections

2021

Ercan, A.M., Çakır, N. - *EARLI 2021 (Book of Abstracts), European Association for Research on Learning and Instruction*.

- Conference paper (EARLI)

Pre-service Math Teachers' Professional Identity Development Through Online Anticipatory Reflections: An Intervention Study

2020

Ercan, A.M. - *PQDT-Global (ProQuest Dissertations & Theses Global)*.

- Cited by 2.
- Master Thesis in English

Hizmet Öncesi Matematik Öğretmenlerinin Çevrimiçi Geleceğe Dönük Yansıtıcı Yazılar Yoluyla Profesyonel Kimlik Gelişimi: Bir Müdahale Çalışması

2020

Ercan, A.M. - *Eğitim Fakültesi (METU)*.

- Cited by 1.
- Master Thesis in Turkish

PROJECTS

Doctoral Research Project: Development and Evaluation of a Digital Femalepreneurship Game Oct 2021 – Dec 2025

Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena, Germany - PhD dissertation project

- Comprised four interrelated sub-projects/studies:
 - **Needs Analysis and Conceptualisation of Femalepreneurship Education:** literature review, needs assessment and identification of entrepreneurial, risk-taking, resilience, and gender-related learning needs.
 - **Digital Game Design and Prototype Development:** design and development of a serious game incorporating entrepreneurship education, risk management, resilience, and gender-related challenges, followed by iterative prototype/alpha testing.

- **Scale Construction:** usability and learning experience evaluation, refinement of the game and development/pilot testing of quantitative and qualitative research instruments.
- **Cross-Cultural Pre-Post Evaluation:** empirical evaluation of the final game with university students in Germany and Türkiye, examining changes in entrepreneurial competencies, risk-taking, resilience, awareness of gender-based discrimination, and the overall learning/game experience.
- The dissertation followed a monograph format rather than a cumulative/article-based dissertation model; therefore, it was conducted the dissertation as a fully independent research project, with the research conception, methodological decisions, study implementation, data collection, analysis, and dissertation writing carried out by the doctoral researcher. The academic chair/supervisor provided doctoral supervision but was not involved as a co-researcher in the individual studies. Under the chair's publication policy, supervisors/advisors were therefore not listed as co-authors of thesis-related publications, and thesis-related articles could not be published during the dissertation-writing phase. Related publications were pursued only after dissertation submission/defense.

WE4STEM - Women Entrepreneurs for STEM

Jan – Apr 2024

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions (MSCA Staff Exchanges), Horizon Europe - Coordinating institution: Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena (CORDIS Grant Agreement ID 101130969)

- EU-funded international/intersectoral project on entrepreneurial education for women in STEM, developing an evidence-based outreach programme to identify and support female STEM graduates with entrepreneurial potential, in collaboration with Università degli Studi di Roma Tor Vergata (Italy), 3S Unternehmensberatung (Austria), and partner institutions in Egypt and Indonesia. Total EU contribution: €561,200.
- Grant agreement signed Aug 2023; project started Jan 2024 and was officially terminated 2 Apr 2024, shortly after launch - consistent with the Marie Curie acceptance being withdrawn/cancelled shortly after the project began.

Teacherpreneur

- Project discontinued following the passing of Prof. Dr. Erdiñ Çakıroğlu (METU, Department of Mathematics and Science Education) in September 2024.

AWARDS & GRANTS

StarTH Gründungsstipendium: K1-Gründungsservice, Uni Jena - Jan 2025 (founding-idea funding, Thüringer Hochschulgründungsnetzwerk)

EXIST-Women Förderprogramm: Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Climate Action - Jan 2024

Impulse Förderung: Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena - Aug 2023 (conference travel/presentation grant supporting participation, with two student mentees, at ECER 2023, University of Glasgow, UK)

Nominee, Best Instructor of the Year Award: Friedrich-Schiller-Universität Jena - Winter 2021 (for teaching Emotional, Cognitive and Affective Domains of Adult Education, in English)

TÜBİTAK Scholarship for Participation in Scientific Activities Abroad: TÜBİTAK - Sept 2021

Jacobs Foundation Presenter Award: EARLI (European Association for Research on Learning and Instruction) - May 2021

Honor Student (x2): Middle East Technical University - Jan & Jun 2016

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

EFIE Mentorinnen-Programm: EXIST – From Science to Business - Dec 2024

CS50's Introduction to Artificial Intelligence with Python: Harvard University - Nov 2024

CS50x: Computer Science 50: Harvard University - Nov 2024

Professional Certificate, Esports Management and Game Development: HP / edX - Nov 2024

Certificate, From Code to Creation: Mastering Game Programming: HP / edX - Nov 2024

Professional Certificate, Writing for Video Games: University of British Columbia - Oct 2024

Certificate, UX Design: HEC Montréal - Nov 2024

Certificates, Game Design / Esports Management: HP / edX - Jan 2024

Certificates, Interactive Narrative / Worldbuilding / Game Writing (x4): University of British Columbia - Jan 2024

Certificate, Generative AI for Games Development: HP / edX - Jan 2024

Sign Language Interpreter Certificate: Middle East Technical University - Feb 2014

Certificate of Community Leadership: Rotary International - Mar 2016

Certificate of Entrepreneurship: TÜBİTAK - Oct 2016

RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research: Mixed-methods research design, adult & continuing education, curriculum development, academic writing, grant acquisition

Technology / AI: AI-supported instructional design, generative AI for education, game-based learning systems

Game Development & Programming: Unity (game engine), C#, Visual Studio (VS); CS50x/CS50 AI curriculum - C, Python, SQL, algorithms, data structures, web development (HTML/CSS/JavaScript), cybersecurity fundamentals

E-Learning & Authoring Tools: Articulate 360, Frontline (LMS/professional development platform)

Design: UX/UI design, instructional design, game design

Entrepreneurship: EdTech startup development, grant-funded research-to-business transfer

LANGUAGES

Turkish: Native / bilingual proficiency

English: Full professional proficiency

German: Full professional proficiency

ACADEMIC & COMMUNITY SERVICE

- Volunteer Teacher - Ehrenamtlicher Gemeindehelfer (Volunteer Educator), Bürgerstiftung Jena - Sept 2025 - Present
- Volunteer, LÖSEV - Feb 2014 - Present
- Volunteer Teacher, Republic of Turkey Ministry of Family and Social Policies - Feb 2014 - 2014
- Committee Founder & Chair of Training Committee, ODTÜ Ar-Ge Topluluğu (METU R&D Community) - Jul 2016 - Jan 2017
- Committee Member, ODTÜ LODOS Topluluğu - Oct 2013 - Jun 2015
- Member, ODTÜ Güzel Sanatlar Topluluğu (METU Fine Arts Community) - Oct 2014 - Jan 2016